Sundry Observations concerning Life and Conduct

7 [1] [a] Excellent speech becometh not a fool;
Much less do [b] lying lips a prince.
8 A [c] bribe is *as* a precious stone in the eyes of him that hath it;
Whithersoever [2] it turneth, [2] it [3] prospereth.
9 He that [d] covereth a transgression seeketh love;
But he that harpeth on a matter [e] separateth chief friends.
10 A [f] rebuke entereth deeper into one that hath understanding
Than a hundred stripes into a fool.
11 [4] An evil man seeketh only rebellion;
Therefore a cruel messenger shall be sent against him.
12 Let a [g] bear robbed of her whelps [h] meet a man,
Rather than a fool in his folly.
13 Whoso [i] rewardeth evil for good,
[k] Evil shall not depart from his house.
14 The beginning of strife is *as* when one letteth out water:
Therefore [l] leave off contention, before there is quarrelling.
15 He that [m] justifieth the wicked, and he that condemneth the righteous,
Both of them alike are an abomination to Jehovah.
16 Wherefore is there a price in the hand of a fool to [n] buy wisdom,
Seeing he hath no [5] understanding?
17 A [o] friend loveth at all times;
And [6] a brother is born for adversity.
18 A man void of [5] understanding [p] striketh hands,
And becometh surety in the presence of his neighbor.
19 [7] He [q] loveth transgression that loveth strife:
He that [r] raiseth high his gate seeketh destruction.
20 He that hath a wayward heart [s] findeth no good;
And he that hath a [t] perverse tongue falleth into [8] mischief.
21 He that [u] begetteth a fool *doeth it* to his sorrow;
And the father of a fool hath no joy.
22 A [v] cheerful heart [9] is a good medicine;
But a broken spirit [x] drieth up the bones.
23 A wicked man receiveth a [y] bribe out of the bosom,
To [z] pervert the ways of justice.
24 [a] Wisdom is before the face of him that hath understanding;
But the [b] eyes of a fool are in the ends of the earth.
25 A [c] foolish son is a grief to his father,
And [d] bitterness to her that bare him.
26 Also to [10] [e] punish the righteous is not good,
Nor to smite the noble for *their* uprightness.
27 He [11] that [f] spareth his words hath knowledge;
And he that is of a [g] cool spirit is a man of understanding.
28 Even a fool, when he [h] holdeth his peace, is counted wise;
[12] When he shutteth his lips, he is *esteemed as* prudent.

18 He that separateth himself seeketh *his own* desire,
And [13] rageth against all [i] sound wisdom.
2 A fool hath no delight in understanding,
But only that his [k] heart may reveal itself.
3 When the wicked cometh, there cometh also [l] contempt,
And with ignominy *cometh* reproach.
4 The words of a man's mouth are *as* [m] deep waters;
[14] The [n] wellspring of wisdom is *as* a flowing brook.
5 To [o] respect the person of the wicked is not good,
[15] *Nor* to [p] turn aside the righteous in judgment.
6 A fool's lips [16] enter into contention,
And his mouth calleth for [q] stripes.
7 A [r] fool's mouth is his destruction,
And his lips are the snare of his soul.

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[a] ch. 24. 7
[b] ch. 12. 22; Ps. 31. 18
[c] ch. 21. 14; Is. 1. 23; Am. 5. 12
[d] ch. 10. 12; Jas. 5. 20; 1 Pet. 4. 8
[e] ch. 16. 28
[f] ch. 9. 9
[g] 2 S. 17. 8; Hos. 13. 8
[h] ch. 29. 9
[i] Ps. 35. 12; 109. 5; Jer. 18. 20
[k] ch. 13. 21; 2 S. 12. 10; 1 K. 21. 22
[l] ch. 20. 3; 25. 8
[m] ch. 18. 5; 24. 24; Ex. 23. 7; Is. 5. 23
[n] ch. 22. 23
[o] ch 18. 24; Ruth 1. 16
[p] ch. 6. 1; 11. 15; 22. 26
[q] ch. 29. 22
[r] ch. 11. 2; 16. 18; 29. 23
[s] ch. 24. 20
[t] Jas. 3. 8
[u] ver. 25; ch. 10. 1; 19. 13

[v] ch. 15. 13
[x] Ps. 22. 15
[y] ver. 8
[z] Ex. 23. 8; Mic. 3. 11; 7. 3
[a] ch. 14. 6
[b] Eccl. 2. 14
[c] ch. 19. 13
[d] ch. 10. 1
[e] ver. 15; ch. 18. 5
[f] ch. 10. 19; Jas. 1. 19
[g] ch. 14. 29
[h] Job 13. 5
[i] ch. 2. 7; 3. 21; 8. 14
[k] ch. 12. 23; 13. 16; Eccl. 10. 3
[l] ch. 12. 8
[m] ch. 20. 5
[n] ch. 10. 11; 16. 22
[o] ch. 17. 15; 24. 23; 28. 21; Lev. 19. 15; Dt. 1. 17; 16. 19; Ps. 82. 2
[p] ch. 17. 26; 31. 5; Ex. 23. 2, 6; Mic. 3. 9

[q] ch. 19. 29

[r] ch. 10. 14; 12. 13; 13. 3; Ps. 64. 8; 140. 9; Eccl. 10. 12

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[1] Or, *Arrogant* [2] Or, *he*
[3] Or, *dealeth wisely*
[4] Or, *A rebellious man* (Heb *Rebellion*) *seeketh only evil* [5] Heb. *heart.*
[6] Or, *is born as a brother*
[7] Or, *He that loveth transgression loveth strife*
[8] Or, *calamity*
[9] Heb. *causeth good healing.* [10] Or, *fine*
[11] Or, *that hath knowledge spareth his words; And a man of understanding is of a cool spirit*
[12] Or, *He that shutteth his lips is &c.*
[13] Or, *quarrelleth with*
[14] Or, *A flowing brook, a wellspring of wisdom*
[15] Or, *So as to turn aside*
[16] Or, *bring contention*

Sundry Observations concerning Life and Conduct

8 The [a] words of a whisperer are
as dainty morsels,
And they go down into [b] the
innermost parts.
9 He also that is [c] slack in his
work
Is [d] brother to him that is a de-
stroyer.
10 The [e] name of Jehovah is a
[f] strong tower;
The righteous runneth into it,
and [1] [g] is safe.
11 The [h] rich man's wealth is his
strong city,
And as a high wall in his own
imagination.
12 [i] Before destruction the heart
of man is haughty;
And [k] before honor *goeth* hu-
mility.
13 He that [l] giveth answer before
he heareth,
It is folly and shame unto him.
14 The [m] spirit of a man will sus-
tain his infirmity;
But a [n] broken spirit who can
[2] bear?
15 The [o] heart of the prudent get-
teth knowledge;
And the [p] ear of the wise seeketh
knowledge.
16 A man's [q] gift maketh room for
him,
And bringeth him before great
men.
17 He that pleadeth his cause first
seemeth just;
But his neighbor cometh and
searcheth him out.
18 The [r] lot causeth contentions to
cease,
And parteth between the
mighty.
19 A brother [3] offended *is harder
to be won* than a strong city;
And *such* contentions are like
the bars of a castle.
20 A [s] man's belly shall be filled
with the fruit of his mouth;
With the increase of his lips
shall he be satisfied.
21 [t] Death and life are in the
power of the tongue;
And they that love it shall eat
the [u] fruit thereof.
22 Whoso findeth a [v] wife findeth
a good thing,
And [x] obtaineth favor of Jeho-
vah.
23 The [y] poor useth entreaties;
But the [z] rich [a] answereth
roughly.

1 Heb. *is set on high.*
2 Or, *raise up* 3 Or, *injured*

[a] ch. 26. 22
[b] ch. 20. 27, 30
[c] ch. 10. 4
[d] ch. 28. 24
[e] Ex. 3. 15
[f] 2 S. 22. 2, 3, 33; Ps. 18. 2; 61. 3; 91. 2; 144. 2
[g] ch. 29. 25
[h] ch. 10. 15
[i] ch. 11. 2; 16. 18; 29. 23
[k] ch. 15. 33
[l] ch. 20. 25; Jn. 7. 51
[m] ch. 17. 22
[n] ch. 15. 13
[o] ch. 15. 14
[p] ch. 15. 31
[q] Gen. 32. 20; 1 S. 25. 27
[r] ch. 16. 33
[s] ch. 12. 14; 14. 14
[t] ch. 12. 13; 13. 3; Mt. 12. 37
[u] ch. 13. 2; Is. 3. 10; Hos. 10. 13
[v] ch. 12. 4; 19. 14; 31. 10–31; Gen. 2. 18
[x] ch. 8. 35
[y] ch. 19. 7
[z] Jas. 2. 3, 6
[a] 1 K. 12. 13; 2 Chr. 10. 13

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[b] ch. 17. 17
[c] ch. 28. 6
[d] ch. 14. 2; 20. 7; Ps. 26. 11
[e] ver. 8
[f] ch. 21. 5; 28. 20; 29. 20
[g] ch. 11. 3
[h] Ps. 37. 7; Is. 8. 21
[i] ch. 14. 20
[k] ver. 7
[l] ver. 9; ch. 21. 28; Ex. 23. 1; Dt. 19. 16–19
[m] ch. 6. 19
[n] ch. 29. 26
[o] ch. 18. 16; 21. 14
[p] ver. 4
[q] Ps. 38. 11
[r] ch. 18. 23
[s] ver. 2
[t] ch. 16. 20
[u] ver. 5
[v] ch. 17. 7; 26. 1; Eccl. 10. 6, 7
[x] ch. 30. 22
[y] ch. 14. 29, 16. 32
[z] Mt. 5. 44; Eph. 4. 32; Col. 3. 13
[a] ch. 16. 14; 20. 2
[b] ch. 14. 35
[c] Gen. 27. 23; Dt. 33. 28; Ps. 133. 3; Hos. 14. 5; Mic. 5. 7
[d] ch. 17. 25
[e] ch. 21. 9, 19; 27. 15

24 [4] He that maketh many friends
doeth it to his own destruc-
tion;
But there is a [5] [b] friend that
sticketh closer [c] than a
brother.

19 [c] Better is the poor that
[d] walketh in his integrity
Than he that is perverse in his
lips and is a fool.
2 Also, [6] [e] that the soul be without
knowledge is not good;
And he that [f] hasteth with his
feet [7] sinneth.
3 The [g] foolishness of man sub-
verteth his way;
And his heart [h] fretteth against
Jehovah.
4 [i] Wealth addeth many friends;
But [8] the [k] poor is separated
from his friend.
5 A [l] false witness shall not be
unpunished;
And he that [9] [m] uttereth lies
shall not escape.
6 [n] Many will entreat the favor of
[10] the liberal man;
And every man is a friend to
him that [o] giveth gifts.
7 All the [p] brethren of the poor
do hate him:
How much more do his [q] friends
go far from him!
[11] He [r] pursueth *them with* words,
but they are gone.
8 He that getteth [12] [s] wisdom lov-
eth his own soul:
He that keepeth understanding
shall [t] find good.
9 A [u] false witness shall not be
unpunished;
And he that [9] uttereth lies shall
perish.
10 Delicate living is [v] not seemly
for a fool;
Much less for a [x] servant to
have rule over princes.
11 The [y] discretion of a man mak-
eth him slow to anger;
And it is his glory [z] to pass over
a transgression.
12 The [a] king's wrath is as the
roaring of a lion;
But his [b] favor is as [c] dew upon
the grass.
13 A [d] foolish son is the calamity
of his father;
And the [e] contentions of a wife
are a continual dropping.

4 Heb. *A man of friends.* 5 Heb. *lover.*
6 Or, *desire without knowledge is not good*
7 Or, *misseth* his way
8 Or, *the friend of the poor separateth himself from him* 9 Heb. *breatheth out.* 10 Or, *a prince*
11 Or, *He pursueth after words,* which *are nought* 12 Heb. *heart.*

Sundry Observations concerning Life and Conduct

14 House and riches are an [a] inheritance from fathers;
But a prudent [b] wife is from Jehovah.
15 [c] Slothfulness casteth into a deep sleep;
And the [d] idle soul shall suffer hunger.
16 He that [e] keepeth the commandment keepeth his soul;
But he that [1] is [f] careless of his ways shall die.
17 He that [g] hath pity upon the poor lendeth unto Jehovah,
And his [h] good deed will he pay him again.
18 [i] Chasten thy son, seeing there is hope;
And set not thy heart on [2] his destruction.
19 A man of great wrath shall bear the penalty;
For if thou deliver *him*, thou must do it yet again.
20 [k] Hear counsel, and receive [3] instruction,
That thou mayest be wise in thy latter end.
21 There are many [l] devices in a man's heart;
But the [m] counsel of Jehovah, that shall stand.
22 That which maketh a man to be desired is his kindness;
And a poor man is better than a liar.
23 The [n] fear of Jehovah *tendeth* to life:
And he *that hath it* shall abide [o] satisfied;
He shall [p] not be visited with evil.
24 The [q] sluggard burieth his hand [r] in the dish,
And will not so much as bring it to his mouth again.
25 [s] Smite a scoffer, and the simple will learn prudence;
And [t] reprove one that hath understanding, *and* he will [u] understand knowledge.
26 He that [v] doeth violence to his father, and chaseth away his mother,
Is [w] a son that causeth shame and bringeth reproach.
27 Cease, my son, to hear instruction
Only to [x] err from the words of knowledge.
28 A worthless witness mocketh at justice;
And the mouth of the wicked [y] swalloweth iniquity.
29 Judgments are prepared for [z] scoffers,
And [a] stripes for the back of fools.

20 [b] Wine is a mocker, [c] strong drink a brawler;
And whosoever [4] erreth thereby is not wise.
2 The [d] terror of a king is as the roaring of a lion:
He that [5] provoketh him to anger [e] sinneth *against* his own [6] life.
3 It is an honor for a man to [7] [f] keep aloof from strife;
But every fool will be quarrelling.
4 The [g] sluggard will not plow by reason of the winter;
[8] Therefore he shall beg in harvest, and have nothing.
5 Counsel in the heart of man is *like* [h] deep water;
But a man of understanding will draw it out.
6 [9] Most men will [i] proclaim every one his own kindness:
But a [k] faithful man who can find?
7 A righteous man that [l] walketh in his integrity,
[m] Blessed are his children after him.
8 A [n] king that sitteth on the throne of judgment
[10] Scattereth away all evil with his eyes.
9 [o] Who can say, I have made my heart clean,
I am pure from my sin?
10 [11] [p] Diverse weights, and diverse measures,
Both of them alike are an abomination to Jehovah.
11 Even a child maketh himself [q] known by his doings,
Whether his work be pure, and whether it be right.
12 The hearing [r] ear, and the seeing eye,
Jehovah hath made even both of them.
13 [s] Love not sleep, lest thou come to poverty;

[r] Ex. 4. 11; Ps. 94. 9 [s] ch. 6. 9, 10; 19. 15; 24. 33

[a] 2 Cor. 12. 14
[b] ch. 18. 22
[c] ch. 6. 9, 10; 24. 33
[d] ch. 10. 4; 20. 4, 13; 23. 21
[e] ch. 16. 17; Lk. 10. 28; 11. 28
[f] ch. 13. 13; 15. 10
[g] ch. 14. 31; 28. 27; Dt. 15. 7, 8; Eccl. 11. 1, 2; Mt. 10. 42; 25. 40; 2 Cor. 9. 6-8; Heb. 6. 10
[h] ch. 12. 14; Lk. 6. 38
[i] ch. 13. 24; 23. 13; 29. 15, 17
[k] ch. 4. 1; 8. 33; 12. 15
[l] ch. 16. 1, 9
[m] Ps. 33. 10, 11; Is. 14. 26, 27
[n] ch. 14. 27; 1 Tim. 4. 8
[o] Ps. 25. 13
[p] ch. 12. 21; Ps. 91. 10
[q] ch. 26. 15
[r] Mt. 26. 23; Mk. 14. 20
[s] ch. 21. 11
[t] ch. 9. 8
[u] ch. 28. 24
[v] ch. 10. 5; 17. 2
[w] ch. 10. 17

[y] Job 15. 16; 20. 12, 13; 34. 7
[z] ch. 9. 12; Ps. 1. 1
[a] ch. 10. 13; 18. 6; 26. 3
[b] ch. 23. 29, 30; Gen. 9. 21; Is. 28. 7; Hos. 4. 11
[c] ch. 31. 4; Is. 5. 22; 56. 12
[d] ch. 19. 12
[e] ch. 8. 36; Num. 16. 33; 1 K. 2. 23; Hab. 2. 10
[f] ch. 17. 14
[g] ch. 13. 4; 19. 24; 21. 25
[h] ch. 18. 4
[i] ch. 25. 14; Mt. 6. 2; Lk. 18. 11
[k] Ps. 12. 1; Lk. 18. 8
[l] ch. 19. 1
[m] Ps. 37. 26; 112. 2
[n] ver. 26; ch. 16. 10; 25. 5
[o] 1 K. 8. 46; 2 Chr. 6. 36; Job 14. 4; Eccl. 7. 20; Rom. 3. 9; 1 Jn. 1. 8
[p] ver. 23; ch. 11. 1, ref.
[q] Mt. 7. 16

1 Heb. *despiseth.*
2 Heb. *causing him to die.* 3 Or, *correction*
4 Or, *reeleth*
5 Or, *angereth himself against him*
6 Heb. *soul.* 7 Or, *cease*
8 Or, *Therefore when he seeketh in harvest, there shall be nothing*
9 Or, *Many a man will meet one that is kind to him* 10 Or, *Winnoweth*
11 Heb. *A stone and a stone, an ephah and an ephah.*

Sundry Observations concerning Life and Conduct

Open thine eyes, *and* thou shalt be satisfied with bread.
14 It is [a] bad, it is bad, saith the buyer;
But when he is gone his way, then he boasteth.
15 There is gold, and abundance of [b] rubies;
But the lips of knowledge are a precious jewel.
16 [c] Take his garment that is surety for a stranger;
And [1] hold him in pledge *that is surety* for [2] foreigners.
17 [d] Bread of falsehood is sweet to a man;
But afterwards his mouth shall be filled with gravel.
18 Every [e] purpose is established by counsel;
And by [f] wise guidance [g] make thou war.
19 He that [h] goeth about as a talebearer revealeth secrets;
Therefore company not with him that [i] openeth wide his lips.
20 Whoso [k] curseth his father or his mother,
His [l] lamp shall be put out in blackness of darkness.
21 An inheritance *may be* gotten [m] hastily at the beginning;
But the end thereof shall not be blessed.
22 [n] Say not thou, I will recompense evil:
Wait for Jehovah, and he will save thee.
23 [p] Diverse weights are an abomination to Jehovah;
And [3] a [q] false balance is not good.
24 A [r] man's goings are of Jehovah;
How then [s] can man understand his way?
25 It is a snare to a man [4] rashly to say, *It is* holy,
And [t] after vows to make inquiry.
26 A [u] wise king winnoweth the wicked,
And bringeth the [v] *threshing*-wheel over them.
27 The [x] spirit of man is the lamp of Jehovah,
Searching all his innermost parts.
28 Kindness and [y] truth preserve the king;
And [5] his throne is upheld by kindness.
29 The glory of young men is their strength;
And the [z] beauty of old men is the hoary head.
30 [a] Stripes that wound cleanse away evil;
And strokes *reach* the innermost parts.

21 The king's heart is in the hand of Jehovah as the watercourses:
He [b] turneth it whithersoever he will.
2 [c] Every way of a man is right in his own eyes;
But Jehovah [d] weigheth the hearts.
3 To do [e] righteousness and justice
Is more acceptable to Jehovah than sacrifice.
4 A [f] high look, and a proud heart,
[6] *Even* the [g] lamp of the wicked, is sin.
5 The thoughts of the [h] diligent *tend* only to plenteousness;
But [i] every one that is hasty *hasteth* only to want.
6 The [k] getting of treasures by a lying tongue
Is a vapor driven to and fro by them that seek [l] death.
7 The violence of the wicked shall [m] sweep them away,
Because they [n] refuse to do justice.
8 The way of him that is laden with guilt is exceeding [o] crooked;
But as for the pure, his work is [7] right.
9 It is [p] better to dwell in the corner of the housetop,
Than with a [q] contentious woman in [8] a wide house.
10 The soul of the wicked [r] desireth evil:
His [s] neighbor findeth no favor in his eyes.
11 When the [t] scoffer is punished, the simple is made wise;
And [9] when the wise is instructed, he receiveth knowledge.
12 [10] The righteous man considereth the house of the wicked,
How the [u] wicked are overthrown to *their* ruin.

[a] ch. 21. 6
[b] ch. 3. 15
[c] ch. 27. 13
[d] ch. 9. 17
[e] ch. 11. 14; 15. 22
[f] ch. 24. 6
[g] Lk. 14. 31
[h] ch. 11. 13
[i] ch. 13. 3
[k] ch. 30. 11; Ex. 21. 17; Lev. 20. 9; Mt. 15. 4
[l] ch. 13. 9; 24. 20; Job 18. 5
[m] ch. 28. 20
[n] ch. 24. 29; Mt. 5. 39; Rom. 12. 17, 19; 1 Thess. 5. 15; 1 Pet. 3. 9
[o] Ps. 27. 14
[p] ver. 10
[q] ch. 11. 1
[r] ch. 16. 9
[s] Jer. 10. 23
[t] Eccl. 5. 4, 5
[u] ver. 8
[v] Is. 28. 27
[x] 1 Cor. 2. 11
[y] ch. 29. 14

[z] ch. 16. 31
[a] ch. 22 15; Ps. 89. 32
[b] Ezr. 6. 22
[c] ch. 12. 15; 16. 2
[d] ch. 16. 2; 24. 12; Lk. 16. 15
[e] ch. 15. 8; 1 S. 15. 22; Is. 1. 11, 16, 17; Hos. 6. 6; Mic. 6. 7, 8
[f] ch. 6. 17; 8. 13
[g] ch. 24. 20
[h] ch. 10. 4; 13. 4
[i] ch. 28. 22
[k] ch. 13. 11; 20. 21
[l] ch. 8. 36; 17. 19
[m] ch. 10. 25; Jer. 30. 23
[n] Am. 5. 7; Mic. 3. 9
[o] ch. 2. 15
[p] ch. 25. 24
[q] ver. 19; ch. 19. 13; 27. 15
[r] ch. 2. 14; Ps. 52. 3
[s] ch. 14. 21
[t] ch. 19. 25

[u] ch. 14. 11

1 Or, *take a pledge of him*
2 Another reading is, *a foreign woman.*
3 Heb. *a balance of deceit.*
4 Or, *rashly to utter holy* words Or, *to devour* that which is *holy*
5 Or, *he upholdeth his throne*
6 Or, And *the tillage*
7 Or, *straight*
8 Or, *a house in common* Heb. *a house of society.*
9 Or, *when one considereth the wise*
10 Or, *One that is righteous . . . he overthroweth the wicked &c.*

Sundry Observations concerning Life and Conduct

13 Whoso [a]stoppeth his ears at the cry of the poor,
He also shall cry, but [b]shall not be heard.
14 A [c]gift in secret [1]pacifieth anger;
And a present in the bosom, strong wrath.
15 It is joy to the righteous to do justice;
[2]But it is a [d]destruction to the workers of iniquity.
16 The man that wandereth out of the way of understanding
Shall [e]rest in the assembly of [3]the dead.
17 He that [f]loveth pleasure shall be a poor man:
He that loveth wine and oil shall not be rich.
18 The wicked is a [g]ransom for the righteous;
And the treacherous [h]*cometh* in the stead of the upright.
19 It is [i]better to dwell in a desert land,
Than with [4]a contentious and fretful woman.
20 There is precious [k]treasure and oil in the dwelling of the wise;
But a foolish man [l]swalloweth it up.
21 He that [m]followeth after righteousness and kindness
Findeth life, righteousness, and honor.
22 A [n]wise man scaleth the city of the mighty,
And bringeth down the strength of the confidence thereof.
23 Whoso [o]keepeth his mouth and his tongue
Keepeth his soul from troubles.
24 The proud and haughty man, [p]scoffer is his name;
He worketh in the [q]arrogance of pride.
25 The [r]desire of the sluggard killeth him;
For his hands [s]refuse to labor.
26 There is that coveteth [t]greedily all the day long;
But the righteous [u]giveth and withholdeth not.
27 The [v]sacrifice of the wicked is an abomination;
How much more, when he bringeth it [5]with a wicked mind!

1 Heb. *bendeth.*
2 Or, *But destruction* shall be *to &c.*
3 Or, *the shades* Heb. *Rephaim.*
4 Or, *a contentious woman and vexation*
5 Or, to atone *for wickedness*

[a] Mt. 18. 30–34; 1 Jn. 3. 17
[b] Jas. 2. 13
[c] ch. 18. 16; 19. 6
[d] ch. 10. 29
[e] Ps. 49. 14
[f] ch. 23. 21
[g] Is. 43. 3
[h] ch. 11. 8
[i] ver. 9
[k] ch. 8. 21; 22. 4; Ps. 112. 3
[l] Job 20. 15, 18
[m] ch. 15. 9; Mt. 5. 6
[n] ch. 24. 5; 2 S. 5. 6–9; Eccl. 7. 19; 9. 15, 16
[o] ch. 12. 13; 13. 3; 18. 21; Jas. 3. 2
[p] ch. 1. 22; 3. 34; 24. 9; Ps. 1. 1; Is. 29. 20
[q] Is. 16. 6; Jer. 48. 29
[r] ch. 13. 4
[s] ch. 20. 4
[t] ch. 15. 27
[u] Ps. 37. 26; 112. 5, 9; Mt. 5. 42; Eph. 4. 28
[v] ch. 15. 8; Ps. 50. 9; Is. 66. 3; Jer. 6. 20; Am. 5. 22

[x] ch. 19. 5, 9
[y] ch. 12. 19
[z] Eccl. 8. 1
[a] ch. 11. 5; Ps. 119. 5
[b] Is. 8. 9, 10; Jer. 9. 23; Acts 5. 38, 39; 1 Cor. 3. 19, 20
[c] Ps. 20. 7; 33. 17; Is. 31. 1
[d] Ps. 3. 8; Jer. 3. 23; 1 Cor. 15. 57
[e] ch. 10. 7; Eccl. 7. 1
[f] ch. 29. 13
[g] ch. 14. 31; Job 31. 15
[h] ch. 14. 16; 27. 12
[i] ch. 3. 16; 21. 20
[k] ch. 13. 15; 15. 19
[l] ch. 21. 23
[m] Eph. 6. 4
[n] ch. 18. 23; Jas. 2. 6
[o] ch. 24. 16; Job 4. 8, ref.
[p] Ps. 125. 3
[q] ch. 19. 17; 2 Cor. 9. 6
[r] Lk. 14. 13
[s] ch. 18. 6; Gen. 21. 9, 10
[t] ch. 26. 20
[u] Ps. 24. 4; Mt. 5. 8
[v] ch. 14. 35; 16. 13

28 A [x]false witness shall perish;
But the man that heareth shall [y]speak so as to endure.
29 A wicked man [z]hardeneth his face;
But as for the [a]upright, [6]he establisheth his ways.
30 There is [b]no wisdom nor understanding
Nor counsel against Jehovah.
31 The [c]horse is prepared against the day of battle;
But [7][d]victory is of Jehovah.

22 A [e]*good* name is rather to be chosen than great riches,
And [8]loving favor rather than silver and gold.
2 The [f]rich and the poor meet together:
Jehovah is the [g]maker of them all
3 A [h]prudent man seeth the evil, and hideth himself;
But the simple pass on, and [9]suffer for it.
4 The reward of humility *and* the fear of Jehovah
Is [i]riches, and honor, and life.
5 [k]Thorns *and* snares are in the way of the perverse:
He that [l]keepeth his soul shall be far from them
6 [m]Train up a child [10]in the way he should go,
And even when he is old he will not depart from it.
7 The [n]rich ruleth over the poor;
And the borrower is servant to the lender.
8 He that [o]soweth iniquity shall reap [11]calamity;
And the [p]rod of his wrath shall fail.
9 He that hath a [12][q]bountiful eye shall be blessed;
For he [r]giveth of his bread to the poor.
10 [s]Cast out the scoffer, and contention will go out;
Yea, [t]strife and ignominy will cease.
11 He that loveth [13][u]pureness of heart,
[14]*For* the [v]grace of his lips the king will be his friend.
12 The eyes of Jehovah preserve *him that hath* knowledge;

6 Another reading is, *he considereth his way.*
7 Or, *deliverance* 8 Or, *favor is better than &c.*
9 Heb. *are mulcted.*
10 Heb. *according to his way.*
11 Or, *vanity* 12 Heb. *good.*
13 Another reading is, *the pure of heart.*
14 Or, *Hath grace in his lips* Or, That *hath grace in his lips*

Sundry Precepts and Warnings

But he [a]overthroweth the words of the treacherous man.
13 The [b]sluggard saith, There is a lion without;
I shall be slain in the streets.
14 The mouth of [c]strange women is a [d]deep pit;
He [1]that is [e]abhorred of Jehovah shall fall therein.
15 Foolishness is bound up in the heart of a child;
But the [f]rod of correction shall drive it far from him.
16 He that [g]oppresseth the poor to increase his *gain*,
And he that giveth to the rich, [h]*shall come* only to want.

17 [i]Incline thine ear, and hear the words of the wise,
And [k]apply thy heart unto my knowledge.
18 For it is a [l]pleasant thing if thou keep them within thee,
If they be established together upon thy lips.
19 That thy [m]trust may be in Jehovah,
I have made *them* known to thee this day, even to thee.
20 Have not I written unto thee
[2][n]excellent things
[3]Of [o]counsels and knowledge,
21 To make thee [p]know [4]the certainty of the words of truth,
That thou mayest [q]carry back words of truth to them that send thee?

22 [r]Rob not the poor, [5]because he is poor;
Neither [6][s]oppress the afflicted in the gate:
23 For Jehovah will [t]plead their cause,
And despoil of life those that despoil them.
24 Make no friendship with a man that is given to anger;
And with a [u]wrathful man thou shalt not go:
25 Lest thou [v]learn his ways,
And get a snare to thy soul.
26 Be thou not one of them that [x]strike hands,
Or of them that are sureties for debts.
27 If thou hast not wherewith to pay,
Why should he [y]take away thy bed from under thee?
28 [z]Remove not the ancient landmark,
Which thy fathers have set.
29 Seest thou a man [7][a]diligent in his business? he shall [b]stand before kings;
He shall not stand before [8]mean men.

23 When thou sittest to eat with a ruler,
Consider diligently [9]him that is before thee;
2 [10]And put a knife to thy throat,
If thou be a [c]man given to appetite.
3 Be [d]not desirous of his [e]dainties;
Seeing they are deceitful food.
4 [f]Weary not thyself to be rich;
[g]Cease [11]from thine own wisdom.
5 [12]Wilt thou set thine eyes upon that which is not?
For [h]*riches* certainly make themselves wings,
Like an eagle that flieth toward heaven.
6 [i]Eat thou not the bread of him that [k]hath an evil eye,
Neither desire thou his dainties:
7 For [13]as he thinketh within himself, so is he:
Eat and drink, saith he to thee;
But his [l]heart is not with thee.
8 The morsel which thou hast eaten shalt thou [m]vomit up,
And lose thy sweet words.
9 Speak not in the hearing of a fool;
For he will [n]despise the wisdom of thy words.
10 [o]Remove not the ancient landmark;
And [p]enter not into the fields of the fatherless:
11 For their [q]Redeemer is strong;
He will [r]plead their cause against thee.
12 [s]Apply thy heart unto [14]instruction,
And thine ears to the words of knowledge.
13 [t]Withhold not correction from the child;
For [15]if thou beat him with the rod, he [u]will not die.

[a] ch. 21. 12
[b] ch. 26. 13
[c] ch. 5. 3, ref.
[d] ch. 23. 27
[e] Eccl. 7. 26
[f] ch. 13. 24; 23. 14
[g] ver. 22
[h] ch. 28. 22
[i] ch. 5. 1
[k] ch. 23. 12
[l] ch. 2. 10
[m] ch. 3. 5
[n] ch. 8. 6
[o] ch. 8. 10
[p] Lk. 1. 3, 4
[q] ch. 25. 13
[r] ch. 23. 10; Ex. 23. 6; Job 31. 16
[s] Zech. 7. 10; Mal. 3. 5
[t] ch. 23. 11; 1 S. 25. 39; Ps. 12. 5; 35. 10; 140. 12; Jer. 51. 36
[u] ch. 29. 22
[v] 1 Cor. 15. 33
[x] ch. 6. 1; 17. 18

[y] ch. 20. 16; Ex. 22. 26
[z] ch. 23. 10; Dt. 19. 14; 27. 17; Job 24. 2
[a] Rom. 12. 11
[b] Gen. 41. 46; 1 K. 10. 8
[c] ver. 20
[d] ver. 6
[e] Ps. 141. 4; Dan. 1. 5, 8, 13, 15, 16
[f] ch. 15. 27; 28. 20; Mt. 6. 19; 1 Tim. 6. 9; Heb. 13. 5
[g] ch. 3. 5, 7; Rom. 12. 16
[h] ch. 27. 24; 1 Tim. 6. 17
[i] Ps. 141. 4
[k] ch. 23. 22; Dt. 15. 9
[l] ch. 26. 24, 25
[m] ch. 25. 16
[n] ch. 1. 7
[o] ch. 22. 28

[p] Jer. 22. 3; Zech. 7. 10
[q] Job 19. 25
[r] ch. 22. 23

[s] ch. 22. 17

[t] ch. 13. 24

[u] ch. 19. 18

[1] Or, *against whom Jehovah hath indignation*
[2] The word is doubtful. Another reading is, *heretofore*.
[3] Or, *In*
[4] Or, *of a certainty the words &c.*
[5] Or, *for*
[6] Or, *crush*
[7] Or, *skilful*
[8] Heb. *obscure.*
[9] Or, *what*
[10] Or, *For thou wilt put*
[11] Or, *by reason of thine own understanding*
[12] Or, *Wilt thou set thine eyes upon it? it is gone:* Heb. *Shall thine eyes fly upon it, and it is not?*
[13] Or, *as one that reckoneth*
[14] Or, *correction*
[15] Or, *though*

Sundry Precepts and Warnings

14 Thou shalt beat him with the rod,
And shalt [a] deliver his soul from Sheol.
15 My son, if thy heart be [b] wise,
My heart will be glad, even mine:
16 Yea, my [1] heart will rejoice,
When thy lips speak [c] right things.
17 Let [d] not thy heart envy sinners;
But *be thou* in the [e] fear of Jehovah all the day long:
18 For surely there is a [2] [f] reward;
And thy [g] hope shall not be cut off.
19 Hear thou, my son, and [h] be wise,
And [i] guide thy heart in the way.
20 Be not among [k] winebibbers,
Among [l] gluttonous eaters of flesh:
21 For the [m] drunkard and the glutton shall come to poverty;
And [n] drowsiness will clothe *a man* with rags.
22 [o] Hearken unto thy father that begat thee,
And [p] despise not thy mother when she is old.
23 [q] Buy the truth, and sell it not;
Yea, wisdom, and instruction, and understanding.
24 The father of the righteous will greatly rejoice;
And [r] he that begetteth a wise child will have joy of him.
25 Let thy [s] father and thy mother be glad,
And let her that bare thee rejoice.
26 My son, [t] give me thy heart;
And let thine eyes [3] [u] delight in my ways.
27 For a harlot is a [v] deep ditch;
And a [x] foreign woman is a narrow pit.
28 Yea, she [y] lieth in wait [4] as a robber,
And increaseth the treacherous among men.
29 Who hath [5] [z] woe? who hath [6] sorrow? who hath contentions?
Who hath complaining? who hath wounds without cause?
Who hath [7] redness of eyes?

[a] 1 Cor. 5. 5
[b] ver. 24, 25; ch. 27. 11; 29. 3
[c] ch. 8. 6
[d] ch. 24. 1, 19; Ps. 37. 1
[e] ch. 28. 14
[f] ch. 24. 14; Ps. 19. 11; 58. 11
[g] Ps. 9. 18
[h] ch. 6. 6
[i] ch. 4. 23; 9. 6
[k] ver. 29, 30; ch. 20. 1; Is. 5. 22; Mt. 24. 49; Lk. 21. 34; Rom. 13. 13; Eph. 5. 18
[l] ch. 28. 7; Dt. 21. 20
[m] ch. 21. 17
[n] ch. 6. 10, 11; 20. 13
[o] ch. 1. 8; Eph. 6. 1
[p] ch. 15. 20; 30. 17
[q] ch. 4. 7; 18. 15; Mt. 13. 44
[r] ch. 10. 1; 15. 20; 29. 3
[s] ch. 27. 11
[t] ch. 3. 1; 4. 4
[u] Ps. 1. 2; 119. 24
[v] ch. 22. 14
[x] ch. 2. 16; 5. 20, ref.
[y] ch. 6. 26; 7. 12; Eccl. 7. 26
[z] Is. 5. 11, 22

[a] ch. 20. 1; 1 S. 25. 36; Is. 5. 11; 28. 7; Eph. 5. 18
[b] Ps. 75. 8
[c] S. S. 7. 9
[d] Job 20. 16
[e] Ps. 91. 13; Is. 11. 8
[f] ch. 2. 12
[g] Jer. 5. 3
[h] ch. 26. 11; Is. 56. 12
[i] ver. 19; ch. 3. 31; 23. 17; Ps. 37. 1
[k] ch. 1. 15; Ps. 1. 1
[l] Is. 30. 12; Jer. 22. 17
[m] Job 15. 35; Ps. 10. 7; 38. 12
[n] ch. 9. 1; 14. 1
[o] ch. 8. 21
[p] ch. 21. 22, ref.
[q] ch. 20. 18
[r] ch. 11. 14, ref.
[s] ch. 14. 6; 17. 16; Ps. 10. 5
[t] Job 5. 4; Ps. 127. 5
[u] ch. 6. 14; 14. 22; Rom. 1. 30
[v] Is. 59. 7
[x] Dt. 20. 8; Job 4. 5; Jer. 51. 46; Heb. 12. 3

30 They that [a] tarry long at the wine;
They that go to [8] seek out [b] mixed wine.
31 Look not thou upon the wine when it is red,
When it sparkleth in the cup,
When it [9] [c] goeth down smoothly:
32 At the last it [d] biteth like a serpent,
And stingeth like an [e] adder.
33 Thine eyes shall behold [10] strange things,
And thy heart shall utter [f] perverse things.
34 Yea, thou shalt be as he that lieth down in the midst of the sea,
Or as he that lieth upon the top of a mast.
35 They have [g] stricken me, *shalt thou say*, and I was not hurt;
They have beaten me, and I felt it not:
When shall I awake? I will [h] seek it yet again.

24 Be not thou [i] envious against evil men;
Neither desire to [k] be with them:
2 For their heart studieth [l] oppression,
And their lips [m] talk of mischief.
3 Through [n] wisdom is a house builded;
And by understanding it is established;
4 And by knowledge are the chambers [o] filled
With all precious and pleasant riches.
5 A [p] wise man [11] is strong;
Yea, a man of knowledge [12] increaseth might.
6 For [q] by wise guidance thou shalt make thy war;
And [r] in the multitude of counsellors there is [13] safety.
7 Wisdom is [s] too high for a fool:
He openeth not his mouth [t] in the gate.
8 He that [u] deviseth to do evil,
Men shall call him a mischief-maker.
9 The [v] thought of foolishness is sin;
And the scoffer is an abomination to men.
10 If thou [x] faint in the day of adversity,
Thy strength is small.

1 Heb. *reins.*
2 Or, *sequel* Or, *future* Heb. *latter end.*
3 Another reading is, *observe.*
4 Or, *as for a prey*
5 Heb. *Oh!* 6 Heb. *Alas!* 7 Or, *darkness*
8 Or, *try* 9 Or, *moveth itself aright*
10 Or, *strange women* 11 Heb. *is in strength.*
12 Heb. *strengtheneth might.* 13 Or, *victory*

11 [a] Deliver them that are carried away unto death,
And those that are [1] ready to be slain [2] see that thou hold back.
12 If thou sayest, Behold, we knew not [3] this;
Doth not he that [b] weigheth the hearts [c] consider it?
And he that [d] keepeth thy soul, [e] doth not he know it?
And shall not he [f] render to every man according to his work?
13 My son, eat thou [g] honey, for it is good;
And the [h] droppings of the honeycomb, which are sweet to thy taste:
14 So shalt thou know [i] wisdom to be unto thy soul;
If thou hast found it, then shall there be a [k] reward,
And thy hope shall not be cut off.
15 [l] Lay not wait, [4] O wicked man, against the [5] habitation of the righteous;
Destroy not his [6] resting-place:
16 For a [m] righteous man falleth seven times, and riseth up again;
But the [n] wicked are overthrown by calamity.
17 [o] Rejoice not when thine enemy falleth,
And let not thy heart be glad when he is overthrown;
18 Lest Jehovah see it, and it displease him,
And he turn away his wrath from him.
19 [p] Fret not thyself because of evil-doers;
Neither be thou [q] envious at the wicked:
20 For [r] there shall be no [s] reward to the evil man;
The [t] lamp of the wicked shall be put out.
21 My son, [u] fear thou Jehovah and the king;
And company not with them that are given to change:
22 For their [v] calamity shall rise suddenly;
And the destruction [7] from them both, who knoweth it?

23 These also are [x] *sayings* of the wise.

[a] Ps. 82. 4; Is. 58. 6, 7
[b] ch. 21. 2; 1 S. 16. 7
[c] Eccl. 5. 8
[d] Ps. 121. 3–8
[e] Ps. 94. 9–11
[f] ch. 12. 14; Job 34. 11, ref.
[g] ch. 25. 16; Ps. 19. 10; 119. 103; S. S. 5. 1
[h] ch. 16. 24; 27. 7; S. S. 4. 11
[i] ch. 2. 10
[k] ch. 23. 18
[l] Ps. 10. 9, 10
[m] Job 5. 19; Ps. 37. 24; Mic. 7. 8
[n] ver. 22; ch. 6. 15; 14. 32; Jer. 18. 17
[o] ch. 17. 5; Job 31. 29; Ps. 35. 15, 19; Obad. 12
[p] Ps. 37. 1
[q] ver. 1; ch. 23. 17
[r] Job 15. 31
[s] ch. 23. 18
[t] ch. 13. 9; 20. 20; Job 18. 5, 6; 21. 17
[u] Rom. 13. 1–7; 1 Pet. 2. 17
[v] ver. 16
[x] ch. 1. 6; 22. 17

To [y] have respect of persons in judgment is not good.
24 He that [z] saith unto the wicked, Thou art righteous,
[a] Peoples shall curse him, nations shall abhor him;
25 But [b] to them that rebuke *him* shall be delight,
And a good blessing shall come upon them.
26 He [8] kisseth the lips
Who giveth a [c] right answer.
27 Prepare thy work without,
And [d] make it ready for thee in the field;
And afterwards build thy house.
28 Be not a [e] witness against thy neighbor without cause;
[9] And [f] deceive not with thy lips.
29 [g] Say not, I will do so to him as he hath done to me;
I will render to the man according to his work.
30 I [h] went by the field of the sluggard,
And by the vineyard of the man [i] void of understanding;
31 And, lo, it was all grown over with thorns,
The face thereof was covered with [10] [k] nettles,
And the stone [l] wall thereof was broken down.
32 Then I beheld, and considered well;
I saw, and received instruction:
33 [m] *Yet* a little sleep, a little slumber,
A little folding of the hands to sleep;
34 So shall thy poverty come as a robber,
And thy want as an armed man.

[y] ch. 18. 5; 28. 21
[z] ch. 17. 15
[a] ch. 11. 26
[b] ch. 28. 23
[c] ch. 16. 24
[d] ch. 27. 23–27
[e] ch. 25. 18
[f] Lev. 6. 2, 3; 19. 11; Eph. 4. 25
[g] ch. 20. 22; Mt. 5. 39; Rom. 12. 17
[h] ver. 30–34; ch. 6. 6–11
[i] ch. 6. 32
[k] Job 30. 7
[l] Is. 5. 5
[m] ch. 6. 9–11; 20. 13
[n] ch. 1. 1

25 These also are [n] proverbs of Solomon, which the men of Hezekiah king of Judah copied out.

2 It is the glory of God to [o] conceal a thing;
But the glory of [p] kings is to search out a matter.
3 As the heavens for height, and the earth for depth,
So the heart of kings is unsearchable.
4 Take away the [q] dross from the silver,

[o] Dt. 29. 29; Rom. 11. 33
[p] Ezr. 6. 1

[q] ch. 26. 23; Ezek. 22. 18

1 Heb. *tottering to the slaughter.*
2 Or, *forbear thou not to deliver*
3 Or, *this man*
4 Or, *as a wicked man*
5 Or, *pasture*
6 Or, *fold*
7 Or, *of their years*
8 Or, *kisseth with the lips*
9 Heb. *And wouldest thou deceive with thy lips?*
10 Or, *wild vetches*

Sundry Similitudes and Moral Lessons

And there cometh forth a vessel
for the [a] refiner:
5 Take away the [b] wicked *from*
before the king,
And his [c] throne shall be established in righteousness.
6 [1] Put not thyself forward in the
presence of the king,
And stand not in the place of
great men:
7 For [d] better is it that it be said
unto thee, Come up hither,
Than that thou shouldest be
put lower in the presence of
the prince,
Whom thine eyes have seen.
8 Go not forth [e] hastily to strive,
[2] Lest *thou know not* what to do
in the end thereof,
When thy neighbor hath put
thee to shame.
9 [f] Debate thy cause with thy
neighbor *himself*,
[3] And [g] disclose not the secret
of another;
10 Lest he that heareth it revile
thee,
And thine infamy turn not
away.
11 A [h] word [4] fitly spoken
Is *like* apples of gold in network
of silver.
12 *As* [5] an [i] ear-ring of gold, and an
[k] ornament of [l] fine gold,
So is a wise reprover upon an
[m] obedient ear.
13 As the [n] cold of snow in the time
of harvest,
So is a [o] faithful messenger to
them that send him;
For he refresheth the soul of
his masters.
14 *As* [p] clouds and [q] wind without
rain,
So is he that [r] boasteth himself
[6] of his gifts falsely.
15 By long [s] forbearing is a [7] ruler
persuaded,
And a [t] soft tongue breaketh
the bone.
16 Hast thou [u] found honey? eat
[v] so much as is sufficient for
thee,
Lest thou be filled therewith,
and vomit it.
17 Let thy foot be seldom in thy
neighbor's house,
Lest he be [8] weary of thee, and
hate thee.

[a] Mal. 3. 2, 3
[b] ch. 20. 8
[c] ch. 16. 12
[d] Lk. 14. 7-11
[e] ch. 17. 14; Mt. 5. 25
[f] Mt. 18. 15
[g] ch. 11. 13
[h] ch. 15. 23
[i] Ex. 32. 2; 35. 22; Ezek. 16. 12
[k] 2 S. 1. 24
[l] Job 28. 17
[m] ch. 15. 31; 20. 12
[n] ver. 25
[o] ch. 13. 17
[p] Jude 12
[q] Jer. 5. 13; Mic. 2. 11
[r] ch. 20. 6
[s] ch. 16. 14; Gen. 32. 4; 1 S. 25. 24; Eccl. 10. 4
[t] ch. 15. 1
[u] Judg. 14. 8; 1 S. 14. 25
[v] ver. 27

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[x] ch. 24. 28; Ex. 20. 16
[y] ch. 12. 18; Ps. 57. 4
[z] Jer. 9. 8
[a] Job 6. 15
[b] Ex. 23. 4, 5; 2 K. 6. 22; 2 Chr. 28. 15; Mt. 5. 44; Rom. 12. 20
[c] Mt. 6. 4, 6
[d] Ps. 101. 5
[e] ch. 21. 9
[f] ver. 13
[g] ch. 15. 30
[h] Ezek. 32. 2; 34. 18, 19
[i] ver. 16
[k] ch. 27. 2

[l] ch. 16. 32

[m] 2 Chr. 32. 5; Neh. 1. 3

[n] 1 S. 12. 17
[o] ver. 8
[p] ch. 17. 7

[q] ch. 27. 8; Is. 16. 2

[r] Num. 23. 8; Dt. 23. 5; 2 S. 16. 12
[s] Ps. 32. 9

[t] ch. 10. 13; 19. 29
[u] ch. 23. 9; 29. 9

18 A man that beareth [x] false wit-
ness against his neighbor
Is a maul, and a [y] sword, and a
sharp [z] arrow.
19 Confidence in an [a] unfaithful
man in time of trouble
Is *like* a broken tooth, and a
foot out of joint.
20 *As* one that taketh off a gar-
ment in cold weather, *and as*
vinegar upon soda,
So is he that singeth songs to a
heavy heart.
21 [b] If [9] thine enemy be hungry,
give him bread to eat;
And if he be thirsty, give him
water to drink:
22 For thou wilt heap coals of fire
upon his head,
And [c] Jehovah will reward thee.
23 The north wind bringeth forth
rain;
So doth a [d] backbiting tongue
an angry countenance.
24 It is [e] better to dwell in the cor-
ner of the housetop,
Than with a contentious woman
in a wide house.
25 *As* [f] cold waters to a [10] thirsty
soul,
So is [g] good news from a far
country.
26 *As* a [11] [h] troubled fountain, and
a corrupted spring,
So is a righteous man that [12] giv-
eth way before the wicked.
27 It is [i] not good to eat much
honey;
[13] So *for men* to [k] search out
their own glory is grievous.
28 [14] He whose [l] spirit is without
restraint
Is *like* a [m] city that is broken
down and without walls.

26 As snow in summer, and as
[n] rain in harvest,
So [o] honor is not [p] seemly for a
fool.
2 As the [q] sparrow in her wander-
ing, as the swallow in her
flying,
So the [r] curse that is causeless
[15] alighteth not.
3 A [s] whip for the horse, a bridle
for the ass,
And a [t] rod for the back of fools.
4 [u] Answer not a fool according
to his folly,
Lest thou also be like unto him.

1 Heb. *Glorify not thyself.*
2 Or, *Lest* it be said *in the end thereof, What will thou do? When &c.*
3 Or, *But*
4 Or, *in due season*
5 Or, *a nose-ring*
6 Heb. *in a gift of falsehood.*
7 Or, *judge*
8 Heb. *full of thee.*
9 Heb. *he that hateth thee.*
10 Or, *weary*
11 Heb. *trampled.*
12 Or, *is moved*
13 Or, *But* for men *to search out their own glory is glory* The Hebrew text is obscure.
14 Or, *He that hath no rule over his spirit*
15 Heb. *cometh not.*

Sundry Similitudes and Moral Lessons

5 [a]Answer a fool according to his folly,
Lest he be [b]wise in [1]his own conceit.
6 He that [c]sendeth a message by the hand of a fool
Cutteth off *his own* feet, *and* drinketh in damage.
7 The legs of the lame hang loose;
So is a [d]parable in the mouth of fools.
8 As one that bindeth a stone in a sling,
So is he that giveth [e]honor to a fool.
9 *As* a thorn that goeth up into the hand of a drunkard,
So is a [f]parable in the mouth of fools.
10 [2]*As* an archer that woundeth all,
So is he that hireth a fool and he that hireth them that pass by.
11 As [g]a dog that returneth to his vomit,
So is a fool that [h]repeateth his folly.
12 Seest thou a man [i]wise in [1]his own conceit?
[k]There is more hope of a fool than of him.
13 The [l]sluggard saith, There is a lion in the way;
A lion is in the streets.
14 *As* the door turneth upon its hinges,
So doth the [m]sluggard upon his bed.
15 The [n]sluggard burieth his hand in the dish;
It wearieth him to bring it again to his mouth.
16 The sluggard is [o]wiser in [1]his own conceit
Than seven men that can [3][p]render a reason.
17 [4]He that passeth by, *and* vexeth himself with [q]strife belonging not to him,
Is *like* one that taketh a dog by the ears.
18 As a madman who casteth [r]firebrands,
Arrows, and death,
19 So is the man that [s]deceiveth his neighbor,
And saith, Am not I in sport?

[1] Heb. *his own eyes.*
[2] Or, *A master workar formeth all things; But he that hireth the fool is as one that hireth them that pass by* The Hebrew text is obscure.
[3] Or, *answer discreetly*
[4] Or, *He that vexeth himself . . . Is* like *one that taketh a passing dog &c.*

[a] Mt. 16. 1-4; 21. 24-27
[b] ch. 3. 7; 28. 11; Rom. 12. 16
[c] ch. 10. 26
[d] ver. 9
[e] ver. 1
[f] ver. 7
[g] 2 Pet. 2. 22
[h] Ex. 8. 15
[i] ch. 3. 7; 26. 5
[k] ch. 29. 20
[l] ch. 22. 13
[m] ch. 6. 9
[n] ch. 19. 24
[o] ver. 5, 12
[p] ch. 27. 11; 1 Pet. 3. 15
[q] ch. 3. 30
[r] Is. 50. 11
[s] ch. 24. 28

[t] ch. 16. 28
[u] ch. 22. 10
[v] ch. 15. 18; 29. 22; 30. 33
[x] ch. 18. 8
[y] Mt. 23. 27; Lk. 11. 39
[z] ch. 25. 4
[a] ch. 10. 18; Ps. 41. 6
[b] ch. 12. 20
[c] ver. 23; Ps. 28. 3; Jer. 9. 8
[d] Mt. 23. 28
[e] Lk. 8. 17
[f] ch. 28. 10; Ps. 7. 15; Eccl. 10. 8

[g] ch. 29. 5

[h] Lk. 12. 19, 20; Jas. 4. 14
[i] ch. 25. 27; 2 Cor. 10. 12, 18; 12. 11

[k] ch. 12. 16

[l] ch. 6. 34
[m] ch. 28. 23; Gal. 2. 14
[n] ch. 20. 30; Ps. 141. 5
[o] Mt. 26. 49
[p] ch. 25. 16

20 For lack of wood the fire goeth out;
And where there is no [t]whisperer, [u]contention ceaseth.
21 *As* coals are to hot embers, and wood to fire,
So is a [v]contentious man to inflame strife.
22 The [x]words of a whisperer are as dainty morsels,
And they go down into the innermost parts.
23 Fervent lips and a wicked heart
Are *like* an earthen [y]vessel overlaid with silver [z]dross.
24 He that [a]hateth dissembleth with his lips;
But he layeth up [b]deceit within him:
25 When he [c]speaketh fair, believe him not;
For there are seven abominations in his heart:
26 Though *his* hatred [d]cover itself with guile,
His wickedness shall be [e]openly showed before the assembly.
27 Whoso diggeth a pit shall [f]fall therein;
And he that rolleth a stone, it shall return upon him.
28 A lying tongue hateth those whom it hath [5]wounded;
And a [g]flattering mouth worketh ruin.

27 Boast not thyself of to-morrow;
For thou [h]knowest not what a day may bring forth.
2 Let [i]another man praise thee, and not thine own mouth;
A stranger, and not thine own lips.
3 A stone is heavy, and the sand weighty;
But a [k]fool's vexation is heavier than they both.
4 Wrath is cruel, and anger is [6]overwhelming;
But who is able to stand before [l]jealousy?
5 Better is [m]open rebuke
Than love that is hidden.
6 Faithful are the [n]wounds of a friend;
But the [o]kisses of an enemy are profuse.
7 The [p]full soul [7]loatheth a honeycomb;
But to the hungry soul every bitter thing is sweet.

[5] Heb. *crushed.* [6] Heb. *a flood.*
[7] Heb. *trampleth upon.*

8 As a [a] bird that wandereth from
her nest,
So is a man that [b] wandereth
from his place.
9 [c] Oil and perfume rejoice the
heart;
So doth the sweetness of a
man's friend *that cometh* of
hearty counsel.
10 Thine own friend, and [d] thy
father's friend, forsake not;
And go not to thy brother's
house in the day of thy
calamity:
Better is a [e] neighbor that is
near than a brother far off.
11 My son, [f] be wise, and make
my heart glad,
That I may [g] answer him that
reproacheth me.
12 [h] A prudent man seeth the evil,
and hideth himself;
But the simple pass on, *and*
suffer for it.
13 [i] Take his garment that is
surety for a stranger;
And hold him in pledge *that is*
surety for a foreign woman.
14 He that blesseth his friend with
a loud voice, rising early in
the morning,
It shall be counted a curse to
him.
15 A [k] continual dropping in a
very rainy day
And a contentious woman are
alike:
16 He that would [1] restrain her
[2] restraineth the wind;
And [3] his right hand encounter-
eth oil.
17 Iron sharpeneth iron;
So a man sharpeneth the
countenance of his friend.
18 Whoso keepeth the [l] fig-tree
shall eat the fruit thereof;
And he that [m] regardeth his
master shall be honored.
19 [4] As in water face *answereth* to
face,
So the heart of man to man.
20 [n] Sheol and Abaddon are [o] never
satisfied;
And the [p] eyes of man are never
satisfied.
21 The [q] refining pot is for silver,
and the furnace for gold;
And a man [r] is *tried* by [5] his
praise.

22 Though thou shouldest [s] bray a
fool in a mortar with a pestle
along with bruised grain,
Yet will not his foolishness de-
part from him.

23 Be thou [t] diligent to know the
state of thy flocks,
And look well to thy herds:
24 For [u] riches are not for ever;
And doth the [v] crown endure
unto all generations?
25 The [6] hay is carried, and the
tender grass showeth itself,
And the herbs of the mountains
are [x] gathered in.
26 The lambs are for thy clothing,
And the goats are the price of
the field;
27 And *there will be* goats' milk
enough for thy food, for the
food of thy household,
And maintenance for thy
maidens.

28 The wicked [y] flee when no
man pursueth;
But the righteous are bold as a
lion.
2 For the transgression of a
land [z] many are the princes
thereof;
But [a] by [7] men of understanding
and knowledge the state
thereof shall be prolonged.
3 A [b] needy man that oppresseth
the poor
Is *like* a sweeping rain [8] which
leaveth no food.
4 They that forsake the law
[c] praise the wicked;
But such as keep the law [d] con-
tend with them.
5 Evil men [e] understand not jus-
tice:
But they that seek Jehovah
[f] understand all things.
6 [g] Better is the poor that walketh
in his integrity,
Than he that is [9] [h] perverse in
his ways, though he be rich.
7 Whoso keepeth the law is a
wise son;
But he that is a companion of
[i] gluttons shameth his father.
8 He that augmenteth his sub-
stance by [k] interest and in-
crease,
Gathereth it [l] for him that
[m] hath pity on the poor.
9 He that turneth away his ear
from hearing the law,

[a] ch. 26. 2; Is. 16. 2
[b] Gen. 21. 14
[c] Ps. 23. 5; 141. 5
[d] 1 K. 12. 6–8; 2 Chr. 10. 6–8
[e] ch. 17. 17; 18. 24
[f] ch. 10. 1; 23. 15; 29. 3
[g] Ps. 119. 42
[h] ch. 22. 3
[i] ch. 20. 16
[k] ch. 19. 13
[l] 2 K. 18. 31; S. S. 8. 12; Is. 36. 16; 1 Cor. 3. 8; 9. 7; 2 Tim. 2. 6
[m] Lk. 12. 42–44; 19. 17
[n] ch. 15. 11; Job 26. 6
[o] ch. 30. 15, 16; Hab. 2. 5
[p] Eccl. 1. 8; 4. 8
[q] ch. 17. 3
[r] Lk. 6. 26

[s] ch. 23. 35; 26. 11; Jer. 5. 3
[t] Jer. 31. 10; Ezek. 34. 12; Jn. 10. 3
[u] ch. 23. 5
[v] Job 19. 9; Ps. 89. 39; Jer. 13. 18; Lam. 5. 16; Ezek. 21. 26
[x] Is. 17. 5; Jer. 40. 10, 12
[y] Lev. 26. 17, 36; Ps. 53. 5
[z] 1 K. 16. 8–23; 2 K. 15. 8–15
[a] ch. 11. 11
[b] Mt. 18. 28
[c] Ps. 49. 18; Rom. 1. 32
[d] 1 K. 18. 18; Neh. 13. 11, 15; Mt. 3. 7; 14. 4; Eph. 5. 11
[e] Ps. 92. 6; Is. 6. 9; 44. 18
[f] ch. 2. 9; Ps. 119. 100; Jn. 7. 17; 1 Cor. 2. 15; 1 Jn. 2. 20, 27
[g] ch. 19. 1
[h] ver. 18

[i] ch. 23. 20

[k] Ex. 22. 25; Lev. 25. 36

[l] ch. 13. 22; Job 27. 17
[m] ch. 14. 31

1 Heb. *hide.* 2 Heb. *hideth.*
3 Or, *the oil of his right hand betrayeth itself*
4 Or, *As water* showeth *face to face, so the heart* showeth *man to man*
5 Or, *that which he praiseth* Or, *that whereof he boasteth*
6 Heb. *grass.* 8 Heb. *without food.*
7 Or, *a man* 9 Heb. *perverse of two ways.*

Sundry Antithetic Proverbs

Even his [a] prayer is an abomination.
10 Whoso causeth the upright to go astray in an evil way,
He shall [b] fall himself into his own pit;
But the [c] perfect shall inherit good.
11 The rich man is [d] wise in [1] his own conceit;
But the poor that hath understanding [e] searcheth him out.
12 When the [f] righteous triumph, there is great glory;
But [g] when the wicked rise, men [2] hide themselves.
13 He that [h] covereth his transgressions shall not prosper;
But whoso [i] confesseth and forsaketh them shall obtain mercy.
14 Happy is the man that [k] feareth alway;
But he that [l] hardeneth his heart shall fall into [3] mischief.
15 *As* a [m] roaring lion, and a ranging bear,
So is a [n] wicked ruler over a poor people.
16 [4] The [o] prince that lacketh understanding is also a great oppressor;
But he that hateth covetousness shall prolong his days.
17 A man that is [p] laden with the blood of any person
Shall flee unto the pit; let no man stay him.
18 Whoso [q] walketh uprightly shall be delivered;
But [5] he that is [r] perverse in *his* ways shall fall at once.
19 [s] He that tilleth his land shall [t] have plenty of bread;
But [u] he that followeth after vain *persons* shall have poverty enough.
20 A [v] faithful man shall abound with blessings;
But he that [w] maketh haste to be rich shall not be unpunished.
21 To [x] have respect of persons is not good;
[6] Neither that a man should [y] transgress for a piece of bread.
22 He that hath an [z] evil eye [a] hasteth after riches,
And knoweth not that want shall come upon him.
23 He that [b] rebuketh a man shall afterward find more favor
Than he that [c] flattereth with the tongue.
24 Whoso [d] robbeth his father or his mother, and saith, It is no transgression,
The same is the [e] companion of a destroyer.
25 He that is of a [f] greedy spirit
[g] stirreth up strife;
But he that [h] putteth his trust in Jehovah shall [i] be made fat.
26 He that [k] trusteth in his own heart is a fool;
But whoso [l] walketh wisely, he shall be delivered.
27 He that [m] giveth unto the poor shall not lack;
But he that [n] hideth his eyes shall have many a curse.
28 When [o] the wicked rise, men hide themselves;
But when they perish, the righteous increase.

29 He that being [p] often reproved hardeneth his neck
Shall [q] suddenly be destroyed, and that without remedy.
2 When the [r] righteous [7] are increased, the people rejoice;
But [s] when a wicked man beareth rule, the people sigh.
3 Whoso [t] loveth wisdom rejoiceth his father;
But he that [u] keepeth company with harlots wasteth *his* substance.
4 The [v] king by justice establisheth the land;
But [8] he that [x] exacteth gifts overthroweth it.
5 A man that [y] flattereth his neighbor
Spreadeth a net for his steps.
6 In the transgression of an evil man there is a [z] snare;
But the righteous doth [a] sing and rejoice.
7 The [b] righteous taketh knowledge of the cause of the poor;
The wicked [9] hath not understanding to know *it*.
8 Scoffers [c] set a city in a flame;
But [d] wise men turn away wrath.

[a] ch. 15. 8; 21. 27; Ps. 66. 18; 109. 7
[b] ch. 26. 27; Ps. 7. 15
[c] Mt. 6. 33; Heb. 6. 12; 1 Pet. 3. 9
[d] ch. 3. 7; 26. 5, 12
[e] ch. 18. 17
[f] ch. 11. 10; 29. 2
[g] ver. 28; Eccl. 10. 5, 6
[h] Job 31. 33; Ps. 32. 3
[i] Ps. 32. 5; 1 Jn. 1. 9
[k] ch. 23. 17
[l] Ps. 95. 8; Rom. 2. 5
[m] ch. 19. 12; 1 Pet. 5. 8
[n] ch. 29. 2; Ex. 1. 14; Mt. 2. 16
[o] Eccl. 10. 16; Is. 3. 12
[p] Gen. 9. 6; Ex. 21. 14
[q] ver. 26
[r] ch. 10. 27
[s] ch. 12. 11
[t] ch. 20. 13
[u] ch. 10. 6; Mt. 24. 45; 25. 21
[v] ver. 22; ch. 20. 21; 1 Tim. 6. 9
[x] ch. 24. 23
[y] Ezek. 13. 19
[z] ch. 23. 6
[a] ver. 20; ch. 21. 5

[b] ch. 27. 5, 6
[c] ch. 29. 5
[d] ch. 19. 26
[e] ch. 18. 9
[f] ch. 15. 27
[g] ch. 15. 18
[h] ch. 29. 25
[i] ch. 11. 25; 13. 4
[k] ch. 3. 5
[l] ver. 18
[m] ch. 11. 24; 19. 17
[n] ch. 21. 13
[o] ver. 12
[p] ch. 1. 24–31; 1 S. 2. 25; 2 Chr. 36. 16
[q] ch. 6. 15
[r] ch. 11. 10; 28. 12; Esth. 8. 15
[s] ch. 28. 15
[t] ch. 10. 1; 15. 20; 27. 11; 28. 7
[u] ch. 5. 10; 6. 26; Lk. 15. 30
[v] ver. 14; ch. 8. 15; 2 Chr. 9. 8
[x] ch. 15. 27
[y] Ps. 5. 9
[z] ch. 22. 5; Eccl. 9. 12
[a] Ex 15. 1
[b] ch. 31. 8, 9; Job 29. 16; Ps. 41. 1
[c] ch. 11. 11
[d] ch. 16. 14

1 Heb. *his own eyes.*
2 Heb. *must be searched for.* 3 Or, *calamity*
4 Or, *O prince that lackest understanding and art a great oppressor, He &c.*
5 Or, *he that walketh perversely in two ways*
6 Or, *For for a piece of bread a man will transgress*
7 Or, *are in authority*
8 Or, *he that imposeth tribute* Heb. *a man of offerings.* 9 Or, *understandeth not knowledge*

9 If a wise man hath a controversy with a foolish man,
[1] Whether he be angry or laugh,
there will be no rest.
10 The [a] bloodthirsty hate him
that is perfect;
[2] And as for the upright, they
seek his life.
11 A [b] fool uttereth all his [3] anger;
But a [c] wise man keepeth it
back and stilleth it.
12 If a [d] ruler hearkeneth to falsehood,
All his servants are wicked.
13 The [e] poor man and the oppressor meet together;
Jehovah [f] lighteneth the eyes
of them both.
14 The [g] king that faithfully judgeth the poor,
His [h] throne shall be established
for ever.
15 The [i] rod and reproof give
wisdom;
But a child left to himself
[k] causeth shame to his
mother.
16 When the wicked [4] are increased, transgression increaseth;
But the [l] righteous shall look
upon their fall.
17 [m] Correct thy son, and he will
give thee rest;
Yea, he will [n] give delight unto
thy soul.
18 Where there is [o] no vision, the
people [p] cast off restraint;
But he that [q] keepeth the law,
happy is he.
19 A servant will not be corrected
by words;
For though he understand, he
will not [5] give heed.
20 Seest thou a man that is [r] hasty
in his [6] words?
There is [s] more hope of a fool
than of him.
21 He that delicately bringeth up
his servant from a child
Shall have him [t] become [7] a son
at the last.
22 An [u] angry man stirreth up
strife,
And a [v] wrathful man aboundeth in transgression.
23 A man's [x] pride shall bring him
low;
But he that is of a [y] lowly spirit
shall obtain honor.

[1] Or, *He rageth and laugheth, and there is no rest* [2] Or, *But the upright care for his soul*
[3] Heb. *spirit.* [4] Or, *are in authority*
[5] Heb. *answer.* [6] Or, *business*
[7] The meaning of the word is doubtful.

[a] Gen. 4. 5–8; 1 Jn. 3. 12
[b] ch. 12. 16; 14. 33
[c] ch. 19. 11
[d] 1 K. 12. 14
[e] ch. 22. 2
[f] Ezr. 9. 8; Ps. 13. 3
[g] Ps. 72. 4; Is. 11. 4
[h] ch. 16. 12; 25. 5
[i] ch. 13. 24; 22. 15
[k] ch. 10. 1; 17. 25
[l] ch. 21. 12; Ps. 37. 34, 36; 58. 10; 91. 8; 92. 11
[m] ver. 15
[n] ch. 10. 1
[o] 1 S. 3. 1; Ps. 74. 9; Am. 8. 11, 12
[p] Ex. 32. 25
[q] ch. 8. 32; Ps. 1. 1, 2; 106. 3; 119. 2; Jn. 13. 17
[r] Jas. 1. 19
[s] ch. 26. 12
[t] ch. 30. 23
[u] ch. 15. 18; 26. 21
[v] ch. 17. 19
[x] ch. 11. 2; 16. 18; 2 S. 22. 28; Dan. 4. 30, 31; Mt. 23. 12; Jas. 4. 6
[y] ch. 15. 33; 18. 12; 22. 4; Is. 66. 2; Lk. 14. 11; 18. 14; Jas. 4. 10

[z] ch. 15. 32
[a] Lev. 5. 1
[b] Gen. 12. 12; 20. 2; Lk. 12. 4; Jn. 12. 42, 43
[c] ch. 18. 10; 28. 25; Ps. 91. 1–16
[d] ch. 19. 6
[e] Is. 49. 4; 1 Cor. 4. 4
[f] ch. 12. 8; Ps. 6. 8; 139. 21, 22
[g] ver. 10; Ps. 69. 4; Mt. 10. 22; 24. 9; Jn. 15. 18; 17. 14; 1 Jn. 3. 13
[h] ch. 31. 1
[i] ch. 12. 1; Ps. 49. 10
[k] ch. 9. 10
[l] Ps. 68. 18; Jn. 3. 13; Eph. 4. 8
[m] Ex. 15. 10; Ps. 135. 7
[n] Job 26. 8; 38. 8, 9
[o] Ps. 24. 2; Is. 45. 18
[p] Rev. 19. 12
[q] Ps. 12. 6; 18. 30
[r] ch. 2. 7;

24 Whoso is partner with a thief
[z] hateth his own soul;
He [a] heareth the adjuration
and uttereth nothing.
25 The [b] fear of man bringeth a
snare;
But whoso [c] putteth his trust in
Jehovah [8] shall be safe.
26 [d] Many seek the ruler's favor;
But a man's [e] judgment *cometh*
from Jehovah.
27 An [f] unjust man is an abomination to the righteous;
And he that is [g] upright in the
way is an abomination to
the wicked.

30 The words of Agur the son of [9] Jakeh; the [10] [h] oracle.

The man saith [11] unto Ithiel,
unto Ithiel and Ucal:
2 Surely I am more [i] brutish than
any man,
And have not the understanding of a man;
3 And I have not learned wisdom,
[12] Neither have I the [k] knowledge
of the Holy One.
4 Who hath [l] ascended up into
heaven, and descended?
Who hath gathered the [m] wind
in his fists?
Who hath [n] bound the waters in
his garment?
Who hath [o] established all the
ends of the earth?
What is his [p] name, and what
is his son's name, if thou
knowest?

5 Every [q] word of God is [13] tried:
He is a [r] shield unto them that
take refuge in him.
6 [s] Add thou not unto his words,
Lest he reprove thee, and thou
be found a liar.

7 Two things have I asked of
thee;
Deny me *them* not before I
die:
8 Remove far from me falsehood
and lies;
Give me neither poverty nor
riches;

Ps. 3. 3; 84. 11 [s] Dt. 4. 2; 12. 32; Rev. 22. 18

[8] Heb. *shall be set on high.*
[9] Or, *Jakeh, of Massa* See Gen. 25. 14.
[10] Or, *burden*
[11] Or, as otherwise read, *I have wearied myself, O God, I have wearied myself, O God, and am consumed: For I am &c.*
[12] Or, *That I should have the knowledge &c.*
[13] Heb. *purified.*

Sundry Observations concerning Men and Things

Feed me with [1] the [a] food that is needful for me:
9 Lest I be [b] full, and [c] deny *thee*, and say, Who is Jehovah?
Or lest I be [d] poor, and steal,
And [2] [e] use profanely the name of my God.

10 Slander not a servant unto his master,
Lest he [f] curse thee, and thou be held guilty.

11 There is a generation that
[g] curse their father,
And bless not their mother.
12 There is a generation that are
[h] pure in their own eyes,
And *yet* are not washed from their filthiness.
13 There is a generation, oh how
[i] lofty are their eyes!
And their eyelids are lifted up.
14 There is a generation whose
[k] teeth are *as* swords, and their [i] jaw teeth *as* knives,
To [m] devour the poor from off the earth, and the needy from among men.

15 The [3] horseleach hath two daughters, [4] *crying*, Give, give.
There are three things that are never satisfied,
Yea, four that say not, Enough:
16 [n] Sheol; and the [o] barren womb;
The earth that is not satisfied with water;
And the fire that saith not, Enough.
17 The eye that [p] mocketh at his father,
And [q] despiseth to obey his mother,
The [r] ravens of [5] the valley shall pick it out,
And the [6] young [r] eagles shall eat it.

18 There are three things which are too wonderful for me,
Yea, four which I know not:
19 The way of an [s] eagle in the air;
The way of a serpent upon a rock;
The way of a ship in the midst of the sea;
And the way of a man with a maiden.

20 So is the way of an [t] adulterous woman;
She eateth, and wipeth her mouth,
And saith, I have done no wickedness.

21 [7] For three things the earth doth tremble,
And for four, *which* it cannot bear:
22 For a [u] servant when he is king;
And a fool when he is [v] filled with food;
23 For an [x] odious woman when she is married;
And a handmaid that is [y] heir to her mistress.

24 There are four things which are little upon the earth,
But they are exceeding wise:
25 The [z] ants are a people not strong,
Yet they provide their food in the summer;
26 The [a] conies are but a feeble folk,
Yet make they their houses in the rocks;
27 The locusts have no king,
Yet go they forth all of them by [b] bands;
28 The lizard [8] taketh hold with her hands,
Yet is she in kings' palaces.

29 There are three things which are stately in their march,
Yea, four which are stately in going:
30 The lion, which is [c] mightiest among beasts,
And [d] turneth not away for any;
31 The [9] greyhound; the he-goat also;
And the king [10] against whom there is no rising up.

32 If thou hast done foolishly in lifting up thyself,
Or if thou hast thought evil,
[e] *Lay* thy hand upon thy mouth.
33 For the [11] churning of milk bringeth forth butter,
And the [11] wringing of the nose bringeth forth blood;
So the [11] forcing of [f] wrath bringeth forth strife.

[a] Job 23. 12; Mt. 6. 11
[b] Dt. 8. 12; 31. 20; Neh. 9. 25; Hos. 13. 6
[c] Josh. 24. 27; Job 31. 28
[d] ch. 6. 30
[e] Ex. 20. 7
[f] Eccl. 7. 21
[g] ch. 20. 20; Ex. 21. 17
[h] ch. 16. 2; Lk. 18. 11
[i] ch. 6. 17; Is. 2. 11; 5. 15
[k] Ps. 57. 4
[l] Job 29. 17
[m] Ps. 14. 4; Am. 8. 4
[n] ch. 27. 20
[o] Gen. 30. 1
[p] Gen. 9. 22
[q] ch. 15. 20; 23. 22
[r] Dt. 28. 26
[s] Dt. 28. 49; Jer. 48. 40; 49. 22

[t] ch. 5. 6
[u] ch. 19. 10
[v] ver. 9
[x] ch. 12. 4
[y] ch. 29. 21
[z] ch. 6. 6-8
[a] Lev. 11. 5; Ps. 104. 18

[b] Joel 2. 7

[c] Judg. 14. 18; 2 S. 1. 23
[d] Mic. 5. 8

[e] Job 21. 5; 40. 4; Mic. 7. 16

[f] ch. 10. 12; 29. 22

1 Heb. *the bread of my portion.*
2 Heb. *handle the name.*
3 Or, *vampire*
4 Or, called
5 Or, *the brook*
6 Or, *vultures*
7 Heb. *Under.*
8 Or, *thou canst seize with thy hands*
9 Or, *war-horse* Heb. *well girt* (or, *well knit*) *in the loins.*
10 Or, *when his army is with him*
11 Heb. *pressing.*

A Mother's Counsel to a King. Description of a Worthy Woman

31 [1]The words of king Lemuel; the [2]oracle which his mother taught him.

2 What, my son? and what, O [a]son of my womb?
And what, O son of my [b]vows?
3 [c]Give not thy strength unto women,
Nor thy ways to [3]that which [d]destroyeth kings.
4 It is not for [e]kings, O Lemuel,
it is not for kings to [f]drink wine;
Nor for princes [4]*to say*, Where is strong drink?
5 Lest they drink, and forget [5]the law,
And [g]pervert the justice *due* to [6]any that is afflicted.
6 Give strong drink unto him that is [h]ready to perish,
And wine unto the [i]bitter in soul:
7 Let him drink, and forget his poverty,
And remember his misery no more.
8 [k]Open thy mouth for the dumb,
In the cause of all such as are [7]left desolate.
9 Open thy mouth, [l]judge righteously,
And minister [m]justice to the poor and needy.

10 A [n]worthy woman who can find?
For her price is far [o]above rubies.
11 The heart of her husband trusteth in her,
And he shall have no lack of [8]gain.
12 She doeth him good and not evil
All the days of her life.
13 She seeketh [p]wool and flax,
And worketh [9]willingly with her hands.
14 She is like the [q]merchant-ships;
She bringeth her bread from afar.
15 She [r]riseth also while it is yet night,
And [s]giveth food to her household,
And their [10]task to her maidens.

16 She considereth a field, and buyeth it;
With the fruit of her hands she planteth a vineyard.
17 She [t]girdeth her loins with strength,
And maketh strong her arms.
18 She perceiveth that her merchandise is profitable;
Her lamp goeth not out by night.
19 She layeth her hands to the distaff,
And her [11]hands hold the spindle.
20 She [u]stretcheth out her [12]hand to the poor;
Yea, she reacheth forth her hands to the needy.
21 She is not afraid of the snow for her household;
For all her household are [v]clothed with scarlet.
22 She maketh for herself [13]*x*carpets of tapestry;
Her clothing is [y]fine linen and [z]purple.
23 Her husband is known [a]in the gates,
When he sitteth among the elders of the land.
24 She maketh [b]linen garments and selleth them,
And delivereth girdles unto the [14]merchant.
25 [c]Strength and dignity are her clothing;
And she laugheth at the time to come.
26 She [d]openeth her mouth with wisdom;
And the [15]law of kindness is on her tongue.
27 She [e]looketh well to the ways of her household,
And eateth not the [e]bread of idleness.
28 Her children rise up, and call her blessed;
Her husband *also*, and he praiseth her, *saying*:
29 Many daughters have done [f]worthily,
But thou excellest them all.
30 Grace is deceitful, and [g]beauty is vain;
But a woman that [h]feareth Jehovah, she shall be praised.
31 Give her of the fruit of her hands;
And let her works praise her in the gates.

[a] Is. 49. 15
[b] 1 S. 1. 11
[c] ch. 5. 9
[d] Dt. 17. 17; 1 K. 11. 1; Neh. 13. 26
[e] Eccl. 10. 17
[f] ch. 20. 1; Is. 5. 22; Hos. 4. 11
[g] ch. 17. 15; Ex. 23. 6; Dt. 16. 19
[h] Job 29. 13
[i] Job 3. 20; Is. 38. 15
[k] ch. 24. 11; Job 29. 12–17; Ps. 82. 3
[l] Lev. 19. 15; Dt. 1. 16
[m] Is. 1. 17; Jer. 22. 16
[n] ch. 12. 4; 19. 14; Ruth 3. 11
[o] ch. 8. 11; Job 28. 18
[p] ver. 21–24
[q] Ezek. 27. 25
[r] ch. 20. 13; Rom. 12. 11
[s] Lk. 12. 42

[t] 1 K. 18. 46; 2 K. 4. 29; Job 38. 3
[u] ch. 22. 9; Dt. 15. 11; Job 31. 16–20; Rom. 12. 13; Eph. 4. 28
[v] 2 S. 1. 24
[x] ch. 7. 16
[y] Gen. 41. 42; Rev. 19. 8, 14
[z] Judg. 8. 26; Lk. 16. 19
[a] Ruth 4. 1, 11
[b] Judg. 14. 12
[c] ver. 17
[d] ch. 10. 31
[e] ch. 19. 15

[f] ch. 12. 4

[g] ch. 6. 25

[h] ch. 22. 4

[1] Or, *The words of Lemuel king of Massa, which &c.* See ch. 30. 1, margin. [2] Or, *burden*
[3] Or, as otherwise read, *them that destroy*
[4] Another reading is, *to desire strong drink.*
[5] Heb. *that which is decreed.*
[6] Heb. *all the sons of affliction.*
[7] Or, *ready to pass away* Heb. *the sons of passing away.* [8] Heb. *spoil.*
[9] Or, *at the business of* [10] Or, *portion*
[11] Heb. *palms.* [14] Heb. *Canaanite.*
[12] Heb. *palm.* [15] Or, *teaching*
[13] Or, *cushio*